DECODE UPSC with Mounika

Reel: Child labour: a 17-year case closes

Reading script · on camera · English + తెలుగు · upload Tue 10 Nov, 6 PM

Script

A child rolling beedis at home: is that legal in India?

ఈ case 17 సంవత్సరాలు Supreme Court లో ఉంది.

Let's decode.

In 2009, a petition challenged a clause of the child labour law that allowed children to work in beedi rolling. Before the Court could decide, Parliament changed the law in 2016.

Now the Supreme Court has closed the case, but with a direction: the Centre must set up a special cell to keep monitoring how the child labour law is enforced, and pass instructions to every state through its Chief Secretary.

So what does the law say today? No child below 14 can be employed in any occupation, except helping the family after school hours or working as a child artist; and adolescents between 14 and 18 cannot work in hazardous jobs.

Prelims trap: Article 24 of the Constitution bans children below 14 only in factories, mines and hazardous work; the complete ban on all occupations comes from the 2016 amendment to the Act, not from the Constitution.

ఇది గుర్తుపెట్టుకోండి!

And with Children's Day coming on November 14, here is the Mains question: why do laws alone fail to end child labour?

మీ answer comments లో రాయండి, and follow for one exam trap every day!

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Title:

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Child Labour: Is It Legal at Home? #UPSC #Shorts
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Description:

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A 17-year-old Supreme Court case on child labour has closed, with a new special cell to monitor the law. Here is everything UPSC can ask.

📌 2009: petition against the beedi-rolling clause → 2016: Parliament amended the Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986
📌 Now: the Supreme Court asks the Centre for a special cell to monitor enforcement, with instructions through every state Chief Secretary
📌 Below 14: no employment in any occupation (except family help after school, child artists) · 14–18: no hazardous work
⚠️ Prelims trap: Article 24 bans children below 14 only in factories, mines and hazardous work; the complete ban comes from the 2016 amendment
✍️ Mains: why do laws alone fail to end child labour? Write your answer in the comments!
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#UPSC #UPSC2027 #ChildLabour #ChildrensDay #Polity #SupremeCourt #APPSC #TGPSC #Group1 #Telugu #Shorts

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🧠 Quick test: Consider these statements:
1. Article 24 prohibits the employment of children below 14 in all occupations.
2. After the 2016 amendment, adolescents aged 14 to 18 cannot work in hazardous occupations.
3. The 2016 amendment allows a child to help the family after school hours.
How many are correct? (a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None
Comment your answer! ✅ Answer: (b) Only two: statements 2 and 3. Article 24 covers only factories, mines and hazardous work.